Electrical Equipment Use Checklist (29 CFR 1910.334)

For supervisors checking an area where extension cords, corded tools, circuits or test instruments are in use.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.334

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item fails, stop use of the equipment or task concerned, remove any damaged item from service and record the corrective action before work continues.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.334: Use of equipment (Part 1910 Subpart S: Electrical) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-334-use-equipment

SECTION A | Cords and portable equipment

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Cord not used for lifting Ref. 1910.334(a)(1)	No equipment is being raised or lowered by its flexible cord.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Cord fastening and routing Ref. 1910.334(a)(1)	No cords held with staples or hung in a way that could damage the jacket or insulation.	☐	☐	☐	
3	External condition Ref. 1910.334(a)(2)(i)	No loose parts, deformed or missing pins, or jacket or insulation damage on cords and equipment.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Signs of internal damage Ref. 1910.334(a)(2)(i)	No pinched or crushed sections of outer jacket.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Pre-use inspection Ref. 1910.334(a)(2)(i)	Items were visually inspected before use on this shift, or have stayed connected in place, unexposed to damage and not relocated.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Damaged items out of service Ref. 1910.334(a)(2)(ii)	Any item with damage that could injure an employee is withdrawn and not used until repaired and tested.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Plug and receptacle match Ref. 1910.334(a)(2)(iii)	Plug and receptacle contacts are proper mating configurations before connection.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Grounding and plug connections

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
8	Grounding conductor in cord Ref. 1910.334(a)(3)(i)	Cords used with grounding-type equipment contain an equipment grounding conductor.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Ground continuity at plug Ref. 1910.334(a)(3)(ii)	No plug or receptacle connected or altered so the ground path is broken where they meet.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Grounding pole unaltered Ref. 1910.334(a)(3)(ii)	No plug or receptacle altered to let the grounding pole enter a current-carrying slot.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Grounding and plug connections

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Adapters Ref. 1910.334(a)(3)(iii)	No adapter in use that interrupts the grounding connection.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Wet or conductive locations Ref. 1910.334(a)(4)	Equipment and cords used where water or conductive liquids are present or likely to be contacted are approved for that location.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Dry hands Ref. 1910.334(a)(5)(i)	Workers plugging or unplugging energized equipment have dry hands.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Wet energized connections Ref. 1910.334(a)(5)(ii)	Insulating protective equipment is used to handle any energized connection that could conduct to the hand, such as a wet connector.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Locking connectors Ref. 1910.334(a)(5)(iii)	Locking-type connectors are fully secured after connection.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Circuits and overcurrent protection

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
16	Switching under load Ref. 1910.334(b)(1)	Circuits under load are opened, reversed or closed only with load rated switches, breakers or designed disconnecting means.	☐	☐	☐	
17	No improvised switching Ref. 1910.334(b)(1)	Non-load-break connectors, fuses, terminal lugs and splices are not used to switch loaded circuits outside an emergency.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Reclosing after a trip Ref. 1910.334(b)(2)	Tripped circuits are not manually reenergized until someone has determined the circuit and equipment can be safely energized.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Repeated resets Ref. 1910.334(b)(2)	No repeated manual resetting of breakers or reenergizing through replaced fuses.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Overcurrent protection Ref. 1910.334(b)(3)	Overcurrent protection is not modified, even temporarily, beyond what 1910.304(e) allows.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Test instruments and flammable materials

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
21	Who is testing Ref. 1910.334(c)(1)	Testing work on electric circuits or equipment is done only by qualified persons.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Test gear inspection Ref. 1910.334(c)(2)	Test instruments, leads, cables, power cords, probes and connectors were visually inspected before use and show no external damage.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Damaged test gear Ref. 1910.334(c)(2)	Damaged test gear that could injure an employee is withdrawn until repaired and tested.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Test gear rating Ref. 1910.334(c)(3)	Instruments and accessories are rated for the circuits and equipment they connect to.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Test instruments and flammable materials

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Test gear environment Ref. 1910.334(c)(3)	Instruments and accessories are designed for the environment where they are used.	☐	☐	☐	
26	Occasional flammable materials Ref. 1910.334(d)	Where flammable gases, vapors, liquids, combustible dust or ignitible fibers are occasionally present, equipment able to ignite them is not used unless measures prevent hazardous conditions.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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